

AI in Sales

Personalization and honest reasoning beat generic scripts

What You Will Learn

- Know where AI genuinely helps a sales workflow (CRM summaries, lead scoring, outreach drafts, objection handling).
- Turn a generic AI-written cold email into a genuinely personalized one.
- Draft objection responses that address the specific concern instead of sounding scripted.
- Defend an AI-suggested lead ranking with reasoning that would satisfy a real manager.

1. Where AI Actually Helps Sales

- **CRM data summarization:** turning a long lead history into a quick "what happened so far" summary.
- **Lead scoring:** ranking which leads are most likely to actually close, based on given signals.
- **Personalized outreach drafts:** a first-draft cold email or follow-up message.
- **Objection-handling scripts:** draft responses to common pushback ("too expensive", "not right now").

2. Personalization vs Generic Spam

An AI-written cold email that only knows the prospect's name and industry will read exactly like every other cold email that prospect gets that week. Real personalization needs at least one specific, verifiable detail about that particular prospect — something that proves a human (or a well-directed AI) actually looked at who they're writing to.

Example — generic vs personalized

Generic: "Hi [Name], I noticed you work in the retail industry and thought our product could help you grow." Personalized: "Hi Priya — saw that your store just expanded to a second location; scaling inventory across two sites is exactly the kind of problem our tool was built for." The second one proves real attention was paid.

3. Handling Objections Without Sounding Scripted

AI can draft a response to a common objection like "it's too expensive", but a response that ignores the specific reason behind that objection sounds scripted and defensive. The best objection responses acknowledge the specific concern first, then respond to it directly — not a generic rebuttal copy-pasted for every conversation.

ACTIVITY 1: Write and Improve a Personalized Cold Email

Step 1. Invent a basic prospect profile: industry, company size, and one specific pain point.

Step 2. Ask AI to draft a personalized cold email using only that information.

Step 3. Read it back and add one more real, specific detail that makes it feel less generic (e.g. a recent company milestone).

Worked example: Prospect: a 20-person logistics company that recently struggled with delayed deliveries during a festival rush. Generic AI draft mentions "logistics challenges" broadly. Improved version specifically references "the festival-season delivery delays many logistics teams faced this year" — a real, timely, specific detail.

ACTIVITY 2: Draft and Rank Objection Responses

Step 1. Ask AI to draft responses to 3 common objections: "too expensive", "not the right time", "already using a competitor".

Step 2. Read all 3 responses out loud.

Step 3. Rank them from most natural-sounding to most scripted-sounding, and rewrite the weakest one.

Worked example: AI's "too expensive" response might open with a generic "I understand budget is a concern..." line used for every objection. Rewritten to sound natural: "Totally fair — can I ask what budget range you were expecting? That'll help me show you the option that actually fits." (responds to the specific concern, not a script).

ACTIVITY 3: Score Leads and Defend the Reasoning

Step 1. Write 3 short mini lead profiles (company size, engagement level, stated budget/urgency).

Step 2. Ask AI to score and rank them by likelihood to close.

Step 3. Imagine your manager asks "why did you rank them that way?" — check if AI's reasoning actually holds up as an answer.

Worked example: Lead A: small company, opened every email, said "need this by next month". Lead B: large company, no email opens, no reply. AI ranks Lead A higher. Manager-test: "Lead A shows active engagement and a stated urgent timeline, both stronger buying signals than Lead B's silence, regardless of company size" — this holds up as a real, defensible reason.